

film review Total Slowdown

SPEED

Director: Vikram Bhatt
Starring: Zayed Khan, Urmila Matondkar, Aftab Shivdasani

Speed is a spectacularly bad film. Director Vikram Bhatt steals the plot of the 2004 thriller *Cellular* and yet his film—about a kidnapped school-teacher who telephones a stranger—remains feverishly incoherent.

The action moves between London (Film City masquerading as London) and Mumbai's Renaissance Hotel peopled by a dozen junior artistes pretending to be an international conference addressed by the Indian prime minister in Britain's capital.



BAD AND WORSE: The cast fails to deliver on acting skills

If the sheer shoddiness of the enterprise doesn't get you, the acting surely will. Each actor works his face furiously, perhaps in the hope that sheer hamming will disguise the lack of craft and content. Urmila Matondkar pouts and weeps. Aftab Shivdasani, wearing a nasty wig and overcoat, grins menacingly. Zayed Khan does his

best imitation of cute-hapless-lover-turned-saviour. But the most memorable is Sophie Chaudhary as a leather-clad dominatrix. She snarls and wields some medieval age weaponry with absolute dexterity. She unintentionally provides a few moments of entertainment in this otherwise banal experience.

by Anupama Chopra

music reviews Mixed Harmony

SAAWARIYA



Sony-BMG
Rs 160

Director-producer Sanjay Leela Bhansali takes deep interest in the music

production of all his films. But unlike *Khamoshi* and *Hum Dil De Chuke Sanam*, the music of *Saawariya* composed by Monty, does not rise to the expectations. Perhaps the best is the title track by Shail Hada, a talent to watch out for. *Thode badmash*, sung by Shreya Ghoshal and composed by Bhansali, seems to be a sequel to *Bairi piya* from *Devdas*. Kunal Ganjawala is impressive in *Mashaallah*. Parthiv Gohil is a surprise voice in *Yoon shabnam*. But there are too many songs and too much melody. An overkill.

recommendations Arty Confluence

DELHI Dancers Raja Radha Reddy and family bring Tripatha, a confluence of dance, music and literature. They commence the festival with their Kuchipudi performances followed by Mohan Veena maestro Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt on November

1. On November 2, Kathak dancer Pandit Rajendra Gangani will perform followed by a Carnatic vocal recital by Sanjay Subramaniam. On November 3, Kuchipudi dancer Yamini Reddy and modern dancers Leah R. Curtis from New York and Gilles Chuye from France present a contemporary production called Harmony of the Body and Soul, followed by a Bharatanatyam recital by Priyadarshini Govind. The next day, the evening starts with a traditional Odissi dance recital by Sharmila Biswas followed by a classical fusion band Mrigya. Classical, folk, Sufi and pop fusion at its best. At Kamani Auditorium.

KOLKATA Paula Sengupta's art starts with the title of the show itself: No. 8



Sengupta's history ride

Shorts Bazaar/# 8 Short Street. The Nuptial Chamber is an extension of the mid-career print-maker's show last year. No. 8 Shorts Bazaar, referred to in 19th century Calcutta maps as Short Street, is Sengupta's mother-in-law's 100-year-old Victorian mansion steeped in history. She presents its nuptial chambers through installations in mixed media, using prints, lacework and crochet. At Akar Prakar from October 30 to November 10.

by Swagata Sen

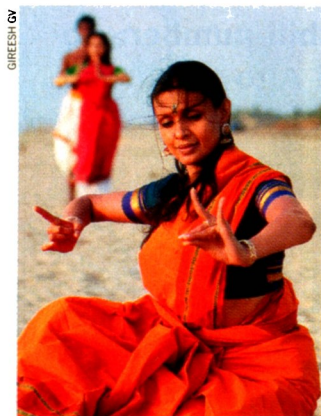
SAMPOORAN



EMI
Rs 195

Fusion bands are getting so inspired by Indian classical music that they are

experimenting with traditional compositions, singing to aesthetically layered modern instrumentation. Pakistan's Mekaal Hasan Band is one that has hopped on to this experimental bandwagon. Their virtuosity and compositional blend of eastern and western influences is impressive, especially in the composition *Sampoorn*, based on the traditional bandish *Sakhi ae ri aali piya bin*, based on Raga Yaman. The harmony is innovative and the band has given a new structure to this age-old composition. Experimenting with Amrita Pritam's *Waris Shah* is a soulful tribute to this great poetess. by S. Sahaya Ranjit



Priyadarshini Govind